

Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland · English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

Zurich (2020–present) · London (2015–2020) · Paris (2013–2014)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Financial services professional with a decade of international experience across London, Zurich, and Paris. Early career in investment banking: Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale covering DACH and Benelux financial institutions, followed by investment and financing work at a London family office. Since 2020, based in Zurich delivering enterprise AI for regulated financial-services organisations. Currently leading the end-to-end AI-automated compliance workflow at a major European reinsurer: strategy, economics, roadmap, and agentic AI implementation across the full regulatory change lifecycle. Prior delivery spans FINMA regulatory reporting, OeNB central-bank audit, and NFR AI practice leadership across the DACH region. CFA charterholder.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, Zurich Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- End-to-end ownership of an AI-automated compliance workflow at a leading European reinsurer: strategy, economics, roadmap, and hands-on implementation of agentic AI across the full regulatory change lifecycle.
- Architecture and delivery of AI-agent workflows for RCSA, TPRM, DORA, and regulatory change, covering LLM orchestration, knowledge graphs, document intelligence, enterprise system integrations, and human-in-the-loop approval gates.
- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local AI and NFR practice, defining go-to-market for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Led origination and end-to-end delivery of a FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme at a leading Swiss insurer, including Databricks data-platform implementation.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, drawing on capital-markets experience across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Coordination across CRO, COO, risk, data, technology, governance, and regulatory stakeholders in regulated financial-services environments.

Single Family Office, London Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

Société Générale, London Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG | DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

Catalina, Paris Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

- Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.
- Statistical analysis of transaction data.
- Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.
- Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

- Enterprise platform built around multiple AI agent workflows, each handling a different NFR domain, with a shared knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approval gates, and enterprise integration patterns. Built as a technical demonstrator of what a production-grade enterprise AI stack looks like in practice.
- Commercial relevance: Individual AI use cases tend to stay isolated from each other. This platform shows what it looks like when they share a knowledge graph, common agent infrastructure, and consistent approval patterns: the architecture of a platform rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line

Enterprise workflow demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

- A fully functional AI workflow demonstrator built around a real regulatory requirement (DORA Article 12). Uses synthetic and anonymized data throughout. Takes a regulatory input through AI-generated control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy-engine verification, compliance documentation, human approval gates, and a complete traceable evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the full architecture of an enterprise AI workflow: model integration (OpenAI o3 for regulatory reasoning, GPT-4o for infrastructure, GPT-4o-mini for documentation), an 11-state machine for end-to-end traceability, and human approval gates at every consequential step. Built using only synthetic and anonymized data.
- Note: Demonstrator using synthetic and anonymized data · no client systems, credentials, or confidential information · integration patterns are illustrative

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

- Interactive tool for modelling the full economics of an enterprise AI platform: model selection and routing, token costs, cloud vs. sovereign vs. on-premise hosting, shared infrastructure costs, governance overhead, and net value projections. Built for executive decision-making and proposal development.
- Commercial relevance: Useful for buyers and architects who need to model the full economics of an AI platform investment: not only capability but also what shared infrastructure and governance overhead do to unit economics.
- Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder
CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments 2014 – 2015
Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University
Cum laude · 8.5/10
Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration 2011 – 2014
Rotterdam School of Management
Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery ·

commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models · NIST AI RMF · shadow AI detection · autonomous operations

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines · Terraform · AWS architecture · Recharts · Vite · TanStack Query · Radix UI · Tailwind CSS · pnpm

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts